The Sādhana of the Bee of Desire

Toh 1280 · Derge Tengyur
བདུ་བ་འདོད་པའི་སྒྲུབ་ཐབས

The Sādhana of the Bee of Desire, known in Tibetan as Bungwa Döpé Druptap, is a brief tantric practice text catalogued as Toh 1280 in the Tengyur, where it belongs among the commentaries and ritual works on the tantras; no Sanskrit title is preserved for it. Set within the Hevajra cycle, it teaches the practitioner, visualized as Heruka, to generate a red bee from the syllables aṃ and hūṃ in the lotus of the heart and to send it out and draw it back on the breath, first to purify and gather in all beings and then, as a rite of attraction, to unite the body, speech and mind of another person with one's own. The text warns that the rite should not be performed where it would cause harm, insisting that one first discern a proper object from an improper one, and it closes with a dedication that all beings may attain compassion. Its colophon attributes it to the accomplished master Ratnacandra and names Khu Ngödrup as the translator.

Herein is contained the Sādhana of the Bee of Desire.

Homage to the Blessed One, glorious Hevajra.

Having paid homage to the enjoyment body,
Born from the cause that is the wisdom of suchness,
I shall explain the sādhana of the bee
In a very condensed form.

At the very outset, one should understand all of the three realms to be mind only. Then, in an instant, one completes oneself in the form of glorious Heruka, resembling a red lotus. In one's own heart one imagines a deep red lotus of eight petals, and on its center one correctly writes with the mind the syllables aṃ and hūṃ: the form in which the āli is perfectly gathered, the syllables devoted with passion to the qualities of all the buddhas. Then from the hūṃ and aṃ one emanates deep red light rays that captivate the mind. Those saffron-like rays pervade all directions; making all sentient beings into one's own form, one summons their body, speech and mind together and places them in the drop of the hūṃ and aṃ.

Then, from the transformation of the hūṃ, one should meditate on the form of a bee, the nature of method and wisdom, jewel-like, the nature of great compassion, intoxicated from drinking the nectar of flowers, ever sounding the

sound whose essence is hūṃ, the nature of Nairātmyā and Heruka. Then in its heart one looks upon a subtle drop, red in color like water in a hide vessel, as the letters aṃ and hūṃ. Then the bee of method and wisdom, riding upon the life wind, is sent out through the nostril; it purifies the body, speech and mind of the sentient beings who dwell in the three realms and gathers them in. Again, relying on the wind of the breath, one does the same: one places them, utterly purified, in the center of the lotus in one's own heart, and one should meditate on the body, speech and mind of others and one's own body, speech and mind as one and equal. In this way, again and again, until one sees it in an instant, one should meditate on the form that relies on the breath.

After becoming accustomed to this, one visualizes in an instant the red eight-petaled lotus of a man or a woman. The bee, its nectar, relying on the life wind and its control, emerges as before and is placed in the center of the flower in one's own heart. Entering the nostril of the person, the form of body, speech and mind dwells in the center of the lotus at the heart. On the petals of that heart lotus is pollen, the nature of the body: meditate on it as one's own body. The nature of speech: drink the lotus. The nature of mind: eat the heart of the lotus. Then the practitioner draws in his own breath wind, sends it out from the person's nostril, and through his own nostril places it in the anthers of the lotus of his heart. Thus, in that body stirred up, one should imagine that the two pollens of the lotus, the nature of the body, have been made one; that the two juices of the flower, the nature of speech, have been made one; and that the two hearts of the lotus, the nature of mind, have been made one. Again, emanating in this way, placing in this way and dissolving in this way, one should contemplate perfectly. Doing this again and again until one sees the signs of attachment, and knowing it to be just as one meditated, one acts, and one accomplishes whatever one desires.

If one performs this meditation here, the woman becomes attached with a joyful mind and, her body overwhelmed by desire, gives bliss to the practitioner's mind and comes under his power. If one sees that there would be wrong in it, one should not do as taught. If one does, it becomes a great wrongdoing. Therefore one should first know what is a proper object and what is not, and having known that, one should meditate as taught.

By the merit of accomplishing
The means of accomplishing the bee of desire,
May beings here in saṃsāra
Obtain glorious compassion.

It is complete. Composed by Ratnacandra, who attained accomplishment. The translator was Khu Ngödrup.

Translator's Notes

• The text has no Sanskrit title line; the title is translated from the Tibetan. "Red like water in a hide vessel" renders ko ba'i chu literally; the intended comparison is uncertain. In "the instant of a man or a woman," skad cig, "instant," is taken adverbially; it may stand for a word meaning "heart." "Life wind and its control" renders srog dang rtsol ba, the Tibetan for prāṇāyāma. "Body stirred up" (lus sprugs) is uncertain. The final caution, that one should first know what is and is not a proper object, makes the use of this rite conditional on ethical discernment.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.